attacked through sanctions or other non-violent means. Not only are the BRICS motivated to support the attacked member because they are fundamentally opposed to such actions on the part of the incumbent powers, but they also want to ensure that such tactics do not succeed, in order to prevent a precedent. They fear that if economic sanctions succeeded in limiting the policy autonomy of one BRICS member, a similar tactic could be used against the others another time.

Proposition 3. Collective financial statecraft among the BRICS countries is more likely when such cooperation promises to provide benefits, or "carrots," that each BRICS government can distribute in its own geographic region, commensurately increasing its own regional status.

Each BRICS country would like to enhance its status as a regional power, and intra-BRICS collaboration in financial statecraft promises the opportunity to access material benefits that might subsequently be distributed to others in each BRICS country's geographic neighborhood. Each of the BRICS countries is a large regional power whose unilateral actions in the region are either feared or seen with some uneasiness by neighboring small powers. BRICS' collective action to address unequal representation in global financial governance, as well as the failures or shortcomings of the incumbent powers, particularly in the aftermath of the global financial crisis, also promises significant benefits to the BRICS in terms of both international and regional status. As the BRICS address these shortcomings of global governance, they signal their commitment to taking the lead in addressing the plight of the "global South" and inequality between the "West" and "non-West," thus potentially enhancing their legitimacy and standing among their regional neighbors.

Proposition 4. Collective financial statecraft among the BRICS countries is more likely when such cooperation promises to appeal to the domestic audience and increase the status of each country's current political leadership within its respective domestic political arena.

BRICS leaders believe that membership in their exclusive club boosts their political fortunes in their respective political systems, despite their large differences in the types of domestic political regime. In a way, this is the same "carrot" strategy as that of each BRICS member in its regional arena, but now their domestic constituencies are the beneficiaries and the audience. The BRICS' actions concerning global governance as they stand up to double standards, hypocrisy,[6] unfairness, and so-called bullying by the